Defence R&D, AYUSH, Science and Engineering Research Board, DCGI and the Directorate General of Health Services. VTF looked at mostly upstream research and essentially became a think tank of all national COVID-related issues and responses. Just like how moving towards a source of a river is considered upstream, VTF was vastly the body contemplating the origins of the virus, how it was spreading in other countries and what proved to be effective strategies to curtail it. VTF also began to keep track of all vaccine candidates—national and global—very early on, and essentially became the interface to initiate talks with all organizations engaged in vaccine research. The first outreach to all potential vaccine makers was made by these folks. VTF used the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) as a central coordinating authority for vaccine development. All related assistance, financial and in kind, would be routed to the vaccine manufacturers via them. The first meeting of this task force was held on 16 April and they went on to hold about 23 meetings until July 2021.[33] VTF was constantly briefing the top office of its recommendations which then trickled down to other arms of the government for speedy resolution.